

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 6 of 6

THE PARTY LEADER LESSON

Lead Your AI Squad

AI does the quest —
YOU check it before it ships.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION • YOU'RE THE PARTY LEADER

Run the Quest



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Everyone is a party member AND a leader. Steps 1–2 you're the leader; in Step 3 you switch and play an AI agent for your team's card; in Step 4 you're the leader again. An AI agent does a multi-step job on its own — and where your card is vague, it guesses forward. So the leader checks, using the loop: **QUEST CARD** → **ROLES** → **CHECK THE LOOT** → **SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK**.

Party = your team of 3; a **party member** does one job. **Roles** = who does which slice. **Quest card** = the job, written down in four parts. **Loot** = the finished work. **SHIP IT** = good to go. **RUN IT BACK** = do it again.

✓ STEP 1 — PICK YOUR QUEST (TEAM OF 3, CHECK ONE)

☐ **GAME NIGHT PAGE** — a one-page flyer that gets grades 6–8 to show up

☐ **CLASS MAGAZINE, ISSUE #1** — the plan for the first issue of a magazine your class makes

✓ STEP 2 — WRITE THE QUEST CARD (ONE PER TEAM; EVERYONE FINISHES IT)

GOAL

What does winning mean?

WHAT WE KNOW

Who is it for, and what does the team already have?

RULES OF THE RUN

Limits: length, to deadline

DONE LOOKS LIKE

The exact thing handed back

✓ STEP 3 — ROLE CARDS (TAKE ONE EACH)

Now switch: for 8 minutes YOU play an AI agent. Do your role's job **SILENTLY** on your own paper — no questions. Papers never move mid-round; at the 4-minute call the Critic reads the Planner's list over their shoulder. Time's up: **everyone passes their OWN paper one seat left** — you're the leader again.

PLANNER

0–4 min: number the steps. Card silent on something (the card doesn't say)? Don't guess — write **"NOT ON THE CARD."** 4–8 min: add a time guess to every step and star the one step most likely to go wrong.

SCOUT

List every fact the quest needs. Mark each ✓ (we know it for sure — say how) or ? (needs checking — say where).

CRITIC

0–4 min: write 2 things the audience on the card cares about. At the 4-minute call, read the Planner's list and write 3 upgrades to it. **"Make it better" is banned.**

THE PARTY LEADER LESSON • LESSON 6 OF 6

Lead Your AI Squad



45 minutes, no prep. The hook: an AI agent does a multi-step job on its own — and where your card is vague, it guesses forward. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Run the Quest worksheet (2 pp; typeable PDF included) • Slides (optional) • scrap paper (1 per student) • board • Teacher Guide	None — unplugged. Optional: projector; your AI account (with-devices block, p.2)	Print worksheets. Plan teams of 3. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Write a four-part **quest card** an agent can't misread. (Step 2; Exit #1)
- Do one **squad role** (planner, scout, critic) silently — no questions asked. (Step 3; Exit #2)
- Review work with the **CHECK rubric**; write a specific run-it-back note. (Step 4; Exit #3)

ISTE 1.6
ISTE 1.7.c

CCSS ELA W.6.4

☑ WARM-UP — IT DID EXACTLY WHAT YOU SAID (7 MIN)

Your new party member: maxed stats, never sleeps, never complains — painfully literal. Last night's run:

"Guard the door." → Guarded the door. Only the door. The enemies came in through the window.

"Grab everything in the chest." → Everything. Including the cursed amulet with the obvious skull on it.

"Wait here." → Still waiting. It has been three in-game days.

Then ask: **whose fault was that — the party member's, or the orders?**

Bridge to AI agent: "An AI agent does a multi-step job on its own — and where your card is vague, it guesses forward. That's why the leader checks. You'll never out-work it. You CAN out-lead it."

What if nobody laughs? Take a fourth order from the room and ruin it too: "Heal me" → healed you. Once.

Transition: "Today you learn the leader's loop: quest card, roles, check the loot — ship it or run it back."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THE PARTY LEADER'S LOOP (10 MIN)

Board: **QUEST CARD** → **ROLES** → **CHECK THE LOOT** → **SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK.**

QUEST CARD — four parts, in writing: **goal** (what winning means), **what we know** (who it's for, what the team has), **rules of the run** (length, tone, deadline), **done looks like** (the exact thing handed back). (If your class did the genie lesson: this is P.R.O. grown up.)

ROLES — nobody solos the raid: a **planner**, a **scout**, a **critic** — same card, one slice each.

CHECK THE LOOT — **accuracy** (facts match the card; every ✓ has a "how we know"), **taste** (fits the audience and tone — or could it be for anybody?), **done-ness** (everything the card asked for?). Weak work gets a run-it-back note: keep + fix.

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

The class doesn't divide by 3 → a team of 4 runs two critics (both read the plan; they'll disagree — great). A team of 2 drops the critic; the leader does the taste check personally.

A leader turns harsh → KEEP before FIX, and the leader reads the note aloud to their party member. Feedback you say to a face stays fair.

A team finishes early → rewrite the quest card so tight the critic can't land a note — or design a fourth squad role and its one-line job.

A card is hopelessly vague and the squad stalls → don't rescue it. "It's not on the card" is the only mid-round answer; in Leader review the RUN IT BACK lands on the card, not the party member. That public, fixable failure is the lesson. (With devices: the projected AI invents a fact — best case. "Which missing rule let it do that?" Add it, run it again.)

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: the Party Leader's Loop instruction (a project broken into four card parts and three roles). Assessed: the Step 2 quest card and Exit Ticket #1, scored with the quest-card scale on p.1.*
- **ISTE 1.7.c** — Students contribute constructively to project teams assuming various roles and responsibilities to work effectively toward a common goal. *Taught: Run the Quest (every student works one role, then leads one review). Assessed: the Step 3 role output (scored against the exemplar squad output, p.1), the Step 4 CHECK rubric and run-it-back note, and Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above). *Taught: quest-card modeling in direct instruction (goal, audience, rules, output). Assessed: Exit Ticket #1 — a four-part quest card written for a real task and audience, scored Proficient / Developing / Beginning.*

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